

> “There are two main pillars of building a developed India of the 21st century. First, pride in our heritage, and second, all possible efforts for development. Today, Uttarakhand is strengthening both these pillars. This decade will be the decade of Uttarakhand.”
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> — ***Narendra Modi, Prime Minister***

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The Uniform Civil Code of Uttarakhand not only promotes unity among citizens of all faiths but also addresses several gender-related issues promoting equal treatment of men and women.

WHY UNIFORM CIVIL CODE

The passage of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) law in Uttarakhand is a significant step towards creating a legal framework for a more equal and unified society. The historic legislation will certainly be remembered as the pioneering step in creating a model for bringing the entire nation under a common set of laws for marriage, divorce, land, and property, regardless of religious affiliation.

It also reflects Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami's commitment to the constitutional vision outlined in Article 44, which says that the state “shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a Uniform Civil Code throughout the territory of India”. The provision is a part of the Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV of the Constitution), which although not enforceable but are the guiding principles of good governance.

The Seventh Schedule of the Constitution provides that both the Centre and state legislatures can legislate on matters pertaining to family laws. In pursuance of this power, the government of Uttarakhand passed its own Uniform Civil Code in the state Assembly on February 6.

The implementation the UCC in the state will now create an inclusive and fair society. The UCC will promote unity and coherence among citizens by establishing a single set of laws that treat all citizens equally, irrespective of their religious beliefs. It also addresses several gender-related issues, including marriage age, promoting equal treatment of men and women.